

Chrome Comes To Android

It took Google ages, but it has finally released a beta Chrome browser for Android, with mobile and tablet versions.

<http://bit.ly/Asuzj0>

Sony Ericsson No More

Sony has finally completed its acquisition of Ericsson's stake in their joint venture – Sony Ericsson is now Sony Mobile Communications.

<http://bit.ly/zKRUXj>

Samsung Galaxy Nexus coming to India in March

Samsung's Android 4.0 Ice Cream Sandwich-based smartphone, Galaxy Nexus, is likely to arrive in India in March. The launch of the Samsung Galaxy Nexus was pushed till January after Samsung said it had "many products" scheduled for December.

Samsung India on its official Twitter account said that the smartphone is going to be launched in March but didn't supply exact dates. In another post, Samsung India promised to give updates



about the Nexus smartphone once it got more information. The official registration page of the handset, however, it still has the product listed as "coming soon".

The Samsung Galaxy Nexus may not be the first ICS-based smartphone in India. Huawei's Honor is reportedly arriving in India in February with the ICS update. It's notable that other manufacturers such as LG and Sony are also rolling out ICS update for their respective premium smartphones. **d**

Windows Phone Tango minimum specs and limitations

New details have been uncovered about the Windows Phone Tango update, by members of the Russian WP7forum, while testing the new OS on a developer device – the HTC Mazaa. While the news brings details about the various improvements that Tango will bring to Windows Phone, it also brings word of the limitations in place for lower-end devices that Tango will enable.

Windows Phone Tango will apparently bring the minimum memory down to measly 256MB

RAM, which brings with it the caveat that Windows Phone devices with that much memory



will not be able to support all apps, their third-party Live Tiles will not work, they won't playback videos with more than a 4Mbps bitrate, they won't be able to upload images auto-

matically to SkyDrive, and, they don't support on-phone podcasts management. Win-

dows Phone Tango's minimum camera configuration is 3MP, compared to 5MP.

Improvements come in the form of SIM contacts migration, enhanced roaming options, automatic app update via Zune, more pre-installed apps, more languages and C++ support (as we've heard before), as well as improved MMS capabilities finally featuring audio/video support, and multiple photo attachments. **d**

Apple top smartphone manufacturer of 2011

According to data by Gartner, Apple was the top smartphone maker of 2011, with the most shipments giving it to 18.9 percent of the market share, up from 15.6 percent last year, when it also led the pack. Samsung comes in a very close second, with less than half a percent difference, at 18.4 percent, up from 8.5 percent last year. Nokia came in third, at 17.9 percent, down from 34.2 percent last year, while RIM came fourth, with a 10.9 percent share, down from 16.6 percent last year. HTC's share rose from 8.2 percent last year, to 9.1 percent this year.

Fourth quarter sales of the iPhone 4S were what gave Apple

the edge against Samsung, with 37 million iPhones sold, giving it a 23.8 percent share in that period. 149 million smartphones were sold in the last quarter of 2011, a 47 percent increase from the same period last year. The report pegs total sales in 2011 at 472 million smartphones glo-



bally, 58 percent more than 2010, accounting for 31 percent of all mobile sales.

In overall smartphone sales by operating system, Android

declined in market share in the last quarter, the same period that saw Apple's iOS-based iPhones doing spectacularly well. While shares dipped, Android still dominated the market, with a share of 51 percent, up from 30 percent in the same period last year. Apple iOS claimed a 23.8 percent share of the market in Q4 2011, compared to 15.8 percent last year.

Overall, across both smartphones and feature phones, Nokia retained its top position with a 23.4 percent market share, while Samsung came in a close second at roughly 19 percent. Apple reaped its smartphone success, taking third place, while ZTE pushed ahead of LG at fourth. **d**